

Critical Security Directive: CVE-2026-8812

EMERGENCY SECURITY DIRECTIVE

Severity: CRITICAL (CVSS Base Score: 9.8) Vulnerability ID: CVE-2026-8812 (Apache Struts RCE) Issued By: Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) Date: August 18, 2026 | 14:00 UTC

Description of Threat: A zero-day Remote Code Execution (RCE) vulnerability has been publicly disclosed affecting Apache Struts versions 2.5.0 through 2.5.30. The vulnerability allows an unauthenticated, remote attacker to execute arbitrary shell commands by manipulating the `Content-Type` HTTP header in a specially crafted request. Active exploitation in the wild has been observed by multiple threat intelligence feeds.

Impact Assessment: An immediate scan of our infrastructure via our vulnerability management tool indicates that 14 internal microservices and 2 public-facing web applications are currently utilizing vulnerable versions of the Struts framework. These applications are primarily tied to our legacy HRIS portal and the B2B vendor inventory system.

Required Actions: This is a priority 1 (P1) directive. All affected development teams must drop current sprint tasks and execute the following remediation steps immediately:

1. Patching: Upgrade the Struts dependency to version 2.5.31 or higher in all `pom.xml` or `build.gradle` files. Force a rebuild and deploy to staging environments by 18:00 UTC today.
2. WAF Mitigation: The network security team has already deployed a virtual patch to our Web Application Firewall (WAF) blocking HTTP requests containing OGNL expressions in the `Content-Type` header. However, this is a temporary stopgap and does not replace the need for patching.
3. Threat Hunting: The Security Operations Center (SOC) is currently reviewing access logs from the past 72 hours for signs of compromise, specifically searching for unusual child processes spawned by the Apache Tomcat user.

All patched services must be pushed to production no later than 23:59 UTC tonight. Exceptions will not be granted. Direct all questions to the #security-incidents Slack channel.